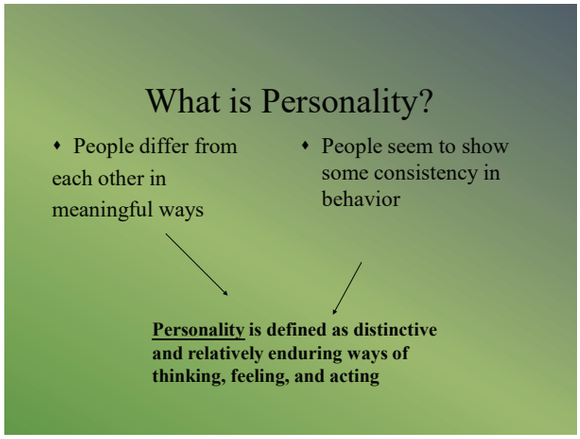
3.10 Personality

Introduction

The word personality has been derived from the Latin word 'Persona' which was the mask which Greek actor wore while acting. This however is not the meaning taken in the modern word personality.



3.10.1 Definition of personality

- Personality refers to a person's unique and relatively stable pattern of thoughts, feelings, and actions
- **Gordon All port defines,** "personality is the dynamic organization within the individual of those psychophysical systems, that determine his unique adjustment to his environment".

3.10.2 Categories of personality

H. J. Evsenck speaks of three basic categories of personality.

- Extroversion - introversion,
- neuroticism - stability and
- psychoticism - normality.

1. **Extroverts** are described as outgoing, uninhibited fond of activities, which bring them into contact with other people**. Introverts** have the opposite traits.
2. **Neuroticism** is a personality trait that includes anxious and nervous behavior and a frequent feeling of fear or worry. In situations of worry, panicking, stress and over emotionality a high level of activity could affect performance adversely in academic work of pupils, resulting in learning disabilities. Stability is opposite of neuroticism
3. **Psychoticism** is a personality type that is prone to take risks, might engage in anti-social behaviors, impulsiveness, or non-conformist behavior. Normality is a opposite of that.

3.10.3 Personality Traits of Successful Nurses

Six important traits for a nurse to be successful is:

1. Tenacious

Nurses need to understand topics like chemistry, anatomy, psychology, and nutrition to do their jobs well. It takes a strong will to memorize all of the information and apply it in hectic environments.

2. Gregarious

Emergency rooms see nearly 130 million patients per day. Most of those patients and their loved ones will rely on nurses to get them through difficult times. Gregarious people who enjoy comforting and helping, however, can thrive in chaotic environments like ER (Emergency Room).But; it is helpful when working in any medical

Nursing-voc_Unit 03.indd 76 22-02-2019 4.44.18 PM